



A PRABHAKAR RAO



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REDISCOVERY OF INDIA

Long sidelined, India's handloom sector has found a silver lining in the pandemic as the appreciation for slow, sustainable fashion grows

IT **may seem that handloom weavers, battered by** demonetisation, the hideously flawed implementation of GST, the lure of synthetic mill-made brands and the whims and fancies of contemporary urban fashion, culminating in two years of Covid-induced lockdowns and the loss of lives and markets, have little to rejoice about. Rarely mentioned in the press, they might be hard-pressed to find good things to say about their marginalised occupation.

"Every cloud has a silver lining" may sound a weary cliche, but it is true for weavers, who after the pandemic find them-